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BSIT 2K

Comparing My Educational Journey with Rizal's

Just like Rizal, I grew up in a family that values education even if we don't have much. His early learning began at home with his mother, and mine did too. My parents taught me to read, write, and ask questions. Rizal studied in Biñan before going to Ateneo, where he experienced both success and hardship (Guerrero, 1998). My journey feels similar. I started in a simple school with limited resources but plenty of heart. That experience shaped my values and work ethic. Rizal experienced discrimination in school because he was a Filipino during Spanish rule (Zaide & Zaide, 2008). While I don't go through the same kind of prejudice, I still feel the pressure of competition, limited opportunities, and expectations from society. These things can be overwhelming, just like how Rizal must've felt being far from home and proving himself in a foreign system. When Rizal went to Europe for further studies, he faced language barriers, homesickness, and financial struggles (Guerrero, 1998). I may not have studied abroad, but I had my own version of that during the pandemic. Studying online made me feel isolated, and it was hard to stay motivated. Like Rizal, I had to push myself to adapt and keep going, even when things got frustrating.

Lessons from Rizal's Journey That Still Matter Today

Early Learning at Home: Rizal's mother taught him how to read and write before he even entered school (Zaide & Zaide, 2008). That reminds me that learning doesn't always have to come from teachers or classrooms. These days, with online tools and tutorials, I can continue learning even outside of school. **Higher Education and Growth:** Rizal didn't study just to get degrees. He wanted to grow as a person and understand the world better (Guerrero, 1998). That inspires me to take every chance to learn, whether it's from free webinars, volunteering, or simply reading up on topics that interest me. **Lifelong Learning Even in Exile:** Even when he was exiled in Dapitan, Rizal kept learning. He taught kids, explored science, and kept writing. That kind of dedication makes me want to use my free time more wisely. Instead of just scrolling on social media, I now try to watch educational videos, read, or explore new skills.

Personal Reflections

There are days when I complain about slow internet or heavy schoolwork. But when I think about how Rizal studied under candlelight, away from home, and without the technology we have now, I realize how privileged I actually am. I may not face the same kind of exile, but sometimes, academic life feels lonely and hard. Still, like Rizal, I want to stay focused and not let those struggles define me.